

ROLLCOG ROOFS

Commercial Roof Inspection Guide

The Complete Checklist for
Property Managers & Facility Directors



27+ Years of Commercial Roofing Excellence

630-655-8256 • office@rollcog.com

rollcog.com

Why Regular Roof Inspections Matter

Your commercial roof is one of your building's most critical assets. Regular inspections help identify small issues before they become costly repairs, protecting your investment and ensuring the safety of everyone inside.

Key Benefits of Regular Inspections:

- **Prevent Costly Repairs**

Catch small problems before they escalate into expensive emergency repairs.

- **Extend Roof Lifespan**

Proper maintenance can add 10-15 years to your roof's service life.

- **Maintain Warranty**

Many manufacturers require documented inspections to honor warranties.

- **Improve Energy Efficiency**

Identify and fix issues that cause energy loss and increased utility bills.

- **Peace of Mind**

Know your building and occupants are protected from the elements.

RECOMMENDATION

Schedule professional inspections twice yearly (spring and fall) and after any severe weather events.

Monthly Visual Inspection Checklist

Use this checklist during your monthly roof walks. Check each item and note any concerns for follow-up with a professional.

- ☐ Check for ponding water or debris buildup on roof surface
- ☐ Inspect membrane for cracks, blisters, or splits
- ☐ Examine flashing around HVAC units, vents, and penetrations
- ☐ Look for signs of pest activity or damage (nests, droppings)
- ☐ Check drains and scuppers for blockages or slow drainage
- ☐ Inspect roof edge and parapet wall condition
- ☐ Note any unusual staining, discoloration, or soft spots
- ☐ Verify all access hatches and skylights are properly sealed
- ☐ Check for loose or missing fasteners and cap sheets
- ☐ Document any changes since last inspection with photos

Notes:

■ **Warning Signs You Need Professional Help**

If you notice any of these issues, contact a professional roofer immediately:

-  **Visible Membrane Damage**
Tears, punctures, or exposed underlayment require immediate attention to prevent water infiltration.
-  **Ponding Water (48+ Hours)**
Water that doesn't drain within 48 hours indicates drainage problems that can lead to roof failure.
-  **Interior Water Staining**
Brown spots or moisture on ceilings/walls mean water is already penetrating your building.
-  **Unexpected Energy Bill Increases**
Sudden spikes may indicate insulation failure or air leaks through the roof system.
-  **Roof Over 15 Years Old**
Commercial roofs have finite lifespans. Regular professional assessment is critical.
-  **After Severe Weather**
Hail, high winds, or heavy snow loads can cause hidden damage that worsens over time.

EMERGENCY? Call Us Now!

630-655-8256

When to DIY vs Call a Professional

Know your limits. Some tasks are safe for in-house maintenance teams, while others require licensed, insured roofing professionals.

DIY / In-House Tasks

- ✓ Monthly visual inspections
- ✓ Clearing debris and leaves
- ✓ Cleaning gutters and drains
- ✓ Documenting conditions
- ✓ Snow removal (soft tools)
- ✓ Reporting issues promptly

Call a Professional

- ★ Membrane repairs/patches
- ★ Flashing replacement
- ★ Warranty inspections
- ★ Penetration sealing
- ★ Full roof assessments
- ★ Emergency leak repairs

SAFETY FIRST

- Always use proper fall protection when accessing the roof
- Never walk on a wet or icy roof surface
- Avoid walking on single-ply membranes in extreme temperatures
- If in doubt about safety or scope, call a professional

ROLLCOG ROOFS

Ready for a Professional Inspection?

Our team of GAF-certified experts is ready to help protect your commercial property.

Schedule Your FREE Inspection

630-655-8256

office@rollcog.com

rollcog.com

GAF Certified

27+ Years Experience

9+ States Served